

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

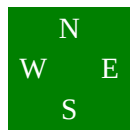
Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 10 5
♥ Q J 10 2
♦ Q 5 4
♣ K 8 6

♠ A 6
♥ K 7 4
♦ A J 9 3
♣ A 9 7 4



♠ 7 3
♥ A 9 5 3
♦ 8 7 6
♣ Q J 10 2

♠ K Q 9 8 4 2
♥ 8 6
♦ K 10 2
♣ 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			

Partner transfers and you naturally respond 2♠.
Partner bids the ♠ game and you pass.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♣Q. West plays the ♣8 and your first decision is whether to hold up.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

You should certainly hold up. West is the Danger hand here because if West ever gets the lead he can play a ♥ through your unprotected ♥K, possibly giving you two ♥ losers. If you take the first trick with the ♣A you open the door for West to gain entry with the ♣K which you know he has.

Next pull three rounds of trumps. Fortune smiles and they split 3-2.

Now it's time to play on ♦s. Do you finesse for the ♦Q? and if so, which way do you finesse?

Missing 6 ♦s to the Queen of course you should finesse. And you will finesse through West, of course, because he is the Danger Hand. So play dummy's ♦K, then play the ♦10 and let it ride.

This time West holds the ♦Q and you make an overtrick, winning 4 ♦ tricks and discarding a ♥ loser from dummy.

Another time East will hold the ♦Q and you will make the contract, but no overtrick.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 5
 ♥ 9 7 5
 ♦ K 8 5 4
 ♣ Q 10 2

♠ K Q J 3

♥ K 10 4

♦ J 9 3

♣ 7 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 8 4

♥ A 6 2

♦ A Q

♣ A J 9 8 5

♠ 10 6 2

♥ Q J 8 3

♦ 10 7 6 2

♣ K 6

West	North	East	South
2NT	Pass	1NT	Pass
All Pass		3NT	
3NT by East			

With 9 points and a balanced hand you go into Invitational Mode. Bid 2NT. Partner will raise to 3NT with a maximum, pass with a minimum. Today he has a middling 16 points, but bids 3NT anyway.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥3 and North plays the ♥K.

Do you hold up or not?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You count 3 ♦ tricks but will need to be careful to get all 3. And obviously your three extra winners will have to be from the ♣ suit.

Most important for now, how do you read the ♥ suit? Do you hold up?

South has 4 ♥s because he led the ♥3 and you can see the ♥2. Therefore you should NOT hold up because they can only win 3 ♥s and the ♣K right now. But if you hold up, North might pocket his ♥ trick and switch to ♠s, where you are just as bad off.

So win the ♥A and unblock the ♦ A Q. then play ♣J, expecting to lose the trick. In fact, South takes his ♣K.

South cashes his 3 ♥ tricks, then plays a ♠. Pounce with dummy's ♠A, cash the ♦K, then take your 4 ♣ tricks and the game.

It was tempting to get over to dummy to try the ♣ finesse. But it was a temptation which had to be ignored. After all, how would you get to dummy? By wasting a ♦ winner? Or by using your only ♠ stopper?

Not all finesses should be taken - certainly not this one.

Another possibility, playing ♣A first, should also be rejected. On the rare day where the ♣K fell singleton you might be happy, but on the more frequent days where a defender held ♣ K x x and took the third ♣ trick you'd feel like a complete fool. Rightly so.